Cleveland Business Mentors

CRM Design & Implementation: Mentor

Version 0.2 | In Progress | March 18, 2026

1. Overview

This document defines the complete CRM design and implementation specification for the Mentor domain within the CRM. It covers all mentor data structures, field definitions, entity relationships, workflows and automation, and role-based security rules.

This document is intended for use by the CBM technology administrator during CRM configuration and by future technical staff onboarding to the platform.

Related documents: CBM-PRD-CRM.docx (platform requirements), CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx (client domain).

2. Data Structure

2.1 Data Model Overview

The mentor domain is built around the native CRM Contact entity. Mentors are not a separate entity — they are Contact records with Contact Type set to Mentor. This approach leverages the CRM's native email integration, activity tracking, and relationship management capabilities without requiring a custom entity for the mentor record itself.

All mentor Contact records are linked to a single shared Company record representing Cleveland Business Mentors (Company Role = Mentoring Company). This anchor relationship distinguishes mentor contacts from client contacts, which are each linked to their own individual client company records.

The entities that make up the mentor domain are:

- Contact — the contacts record that defines each mentor, co-mentor, SME, Presentor, or other CBM people, built on the CRM's native Contact entity
- Company — the Cleveland Business Mentors organization record, serving as the shared anchor for all mentor, co-mentor, SME, Presenter contacts
- Engagement — the active mentoring relationship between a mentor and a client business

- Session — individual meeting records logged by the mentor
- SME Request — records tracking subject matter expert requests initiated by mentors
- Dues — annual dues payment records linked to the mentor contact

Full specifications for Engagement and Session are defined in CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx. SME Request and Dues entity definitions are documented in Sections 3.3 and 3.5 of this document respectively.

2.2 Mentor Contact Fields

Fields are organized into five groups reflecting how they are used in the CRM's layout panels. Native CRM Contact fields are noted where applicable.

Group 1 — Identity & Contact Information

Field	Description / Values
First Name	Native CRM field. Required. Text field.
Last Name	Native CRM field. Required. Text field.
Middle Name	Optional. Text field.
Preferred Name	Optional. Text field. The name the mentor prefers to be called. Used in communications and mentor profile.
Personal Email	Native CRM field. Required. Email field. The mentor's personal email address — not their CBM Gmail. Used for initial onboarding communications prior to CBM Gmail activation.
CBM Gmail Address	Admin-populated. Email field. The mentor's assigned CBM Google Workspace email address (e.g., jsmith@clevelandbusinessmentors.org). Populated by admin during mentor activation. Used for all ongoing mentoring communications.
Phone	Native CRM field. Optional. Phone field.
LinkedIn Profile	Optional. URL field. Collected on the mentor application form.
Address	Native CRM field. Optional. Address field (street, city, state, zip).

Group 2 — Biographical & Professional

Field	Description / Values
Professional Title	Optional. Text field. Current job title or role.
Current Employer	Optional. Text field. Name of current employer or organization.
Currently Employed	Optional. Boolean (checkbox). Collected on the mentor application form. Indicates whether the mentor is currently employed at time of application.

Field	Description / Values
Years of Business Experience	
Years of Business Experience	Optional. Integer field. Used for mentor profile and matching.
Professional Bio / Work Experience	Optional. Rich text field. Collected on the mentor application form as "Describe Your Work Experience." Used for mentor profiles and matching communications.

Group 3 — Skills & Expertise

Field	Description / Values
NAICS Sectors	Required. Multi-select dropdown. Values aligned with the Company NAICS Sector dropdown. One or more sectors may be selected. Used for mentor–client matching.
Mentoring Focus Areas	Required. Multi-select dropdown. Values aligned with the Company Mentoring Focus Areas field. Used for mentor–client matching and funder reporting.
Skills & Expertise Tags	Optional. Multi-select dropdown. Finer-grained expertise tags defined by CBM leadership. Supports advanced mentor matching. Values TBD.
Fluent Languages	Optional. Multi-select dropdown. Languages the mentor is fluent in. Values TBD. Collected on the mentor application form.
Why Interested in Mentoring	Optional. Rich text field. Collected on the mentor application form. The mentor's stated motivation for joining CBM as a mentor.
How Did You Hear About CBM	Optional. Dropdown. Values TBD. Collected on the mentor application form. Used for outreach and referral tracking.

Group 4 — Role & Capacity

Field	Description / Values
Is Mentor	Required. Boolean (checkbox). Flags this contact as eligible for primary mentor assignments.
Is Co-Mentor	Required. Boolean (checkbox). Flags this contact as eligible for co-mentor assignments.
Is SME	Required. Boolean (checkbox). Flags this contact as eligible for SME assignments.
Mentor Status	Required. Dropdown. Values: Submitted | Provisional | Declined | Active | Inactive | Departed. See Section 4.1 for the registration workflow that governs the Submitted → Provisional and Submitted → Declined transitions. See Section 4.2 for the activation workflow that governs the Provisional → Active transition.
Accepting New Clients	Required. Boolean (checkbox). Whether the mentor is currently available for new client assignments. Relevant only when Mentor Status = Active. Mentor-editable.
Maximum Client Capacity	Required. Integer field. The maximum number of simultaneous active client engagements this mentor will accept. Mentor-editable.
Current Active Clients	System-calculated. Read-only. Integer field. Count of Engagements where this mentor is assigned as Primary Mentor and Engagement status is Active or

Field	Description / Values
	Assigned.
Available Capacity	System-calculated. Read-only. Integer field. Maximum Client Capacity minus Current Active Clients. Used by admin during mentor nomination to verify capacity before assignment.

Group 5 — Administrative

Field	Description / Values
Ethics Agreement Accepted	Boolean (checkbox). Admin-only. Whether the mentor has accepted the current CBM ethics agreement.
Ethics Agreement Acceptance Date/Time	Date/Time field. Admin-only. Date and time of the mentor's most recent ethics agreement acceptance.
Background Check Completed	Boolean (checkbox). Admin-only. Whether a background check has been completed for this mentor.
Background Check Date	Date field. Admin-only. Date the background check was completed.
Terms & Conditions Accepted	Boolean (checkbox). System-populated from the mentor application form. Whether the mentor has accepted the current CBM terms and conditions. Admin-only.
Terms & Conditions Acceptance Date/Time	Date/Time field. System-populated from the mentor application form. Date and time of the mentor's most recent terms and conditions acceptance. Admin-only.
Felony Conviction	Boolean (checkbox). System-populated from the mentor application form. Indicates whether the mentor disclosed a felony conviction on their application. Admin-only. Restricted field.
Mentor Training Completed	
Mentor Training Completed	Boolean (checkbox). System-populated via LMS integration when required training is completed. Read-only.
Mentor Completion Date	Date field. System-populated. Read-only. Date required Mentor training was completed.
Dues Status	Dropdown. Values: Unpaid | Paid | Waived. Admin-only. Tracks the mentor's current-year dues standing.
Dues Payment Date	Date field. Admin-only. Date of most recent dues payment. Not applicable when Dues Status = Waived.
Departure Reason	Dropdown. Values: Relocated | Career Change | Time Constraints | Personal | Other. Admin-only. Shown only when Mentor Status = Departed.
Departure Date	Date field. Admin-only. Date the mentor formally departed. Shown only when Mentor Status = Departed.

3. Relationships

3.1 Mentor → Engagement

This is the primary relationship in the mentor domain. A mentor Contact may be linked to multiple Engagements over time in one of three roles: Primary Mentor, Co-Mentor, or SME.

The Primary Mentor is stored as a single lookup field on the Engagement record. Co-Mentor and SME assignments are stored as many-to-many relationship panels, allowing multiple Co-Mentors and multiple SMEs to be linked to a single Engagement simultaneously.

The Primary Mentor link is set by an admin during the mentor nomination process when the Engagement moves from Submitted to Pending Acceptance. Co-Mentor and SME links are optional and may be added at any time during an active Engagement.

From the mentor Contact record, three relationship panels provide visibility into all Engagements where the mentor is assigned: one panel for Primary Mentor assignments, one for Co-Mentor assignments, and one for SME assignments. This allows a mentor serving in multiple roles across different Engagements to see all their assignments from a single record.

3.2 Mentor → Client

There is no direct relationship between a mentor Contact record and a client Contact or Company record. Mentors access client information exclusively through their assigned Engagements. A mentor can see only the Companies and Contacts linked to Engagements where they are assigned as Primary Mentor, Co-Mentor, or SME.

This design is intentional — it enforces access scoping at the data model level rather than relying solely on role-based permissions. A mentor has no visibility into clients they are not actively assigned to, even if those clients exist in the system.

3.3 Mentor → Session

The relationship between a mentor Contact and a Session record captures physical attendance — which mentors were actually present at the meeting. This is distinct from Engagement assignment: a co-mentor may log a session that the primary mentor did not attend, and the session record must reflect that accurately.

Relationship type: Many-to-many. A Session may have multiple mentor attendees; a mentor Contact may be listed as an attendee on multiple Sessions.

The Session record includes a Mentor Attendees relationship panel listing all mentor Contacts who participated in that session. At least one Contact from a Mentoring Company (Company Role = Mentoring Company) must be added to this panel before the Session record can be saved. This is enforced as a save validation rule in the CRM.

The mentor who logs the session and the mentors listed in the Mentor Attendees panel are independent — the logger need not be an attendee, and attendees need not be the logger.

From the mentor Contact record, all Sessions where they are listed as an attendee are visible in a Session Attendees relationship panel.

Note: The Session entity definition in CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx (Section 2.5) must be updated to include the Mentor Attendees many-to-many relationship panel and the save validation rule described above. This update will be made upon completion of the Mentor PRD.

3.4 Mentor → Dues

Relationship type: One-to-many. One mentor Contact may have many Dues records over time — one record per billing year. Each Dues record belongs to exactly one mentor Contact.

Dues records are created annually by the admin or by automated billing workflow. They track the invoice, payment status, and payment date for each mentor's annual dues obligation.

From the mentor Contact record, all linked Dues records are visible in a Dues relationship panel, providing a full dues payment history for the mentor. The Dues Status field on the mentor Contact record (Unpaid / Paid / Waived) is maintained manually by the admin and is independent of the individual Dues records, which serve as the detailed payment history.

Note: The full Dues entity field definition is documented in Section 4.6 (Dues Billing & Collection) of this document.

4. Processes & Workflows

4.1 Mentor Registration

The registration process begins when a prospective mentor submits an application via the CBM website. The form is built in WordPress and posts data to the CRM via the REST API.

Prospective mentor navigates to the mentor application page on the CBM website and completes the application form. The form collects: Why Interested in Mentoring, First Name, Middle Name, Last Name, Preferred Name, Personal Email, Street Address, Phone, Professional Bio / Work Experience, LinkedIn Profile URL, Currently Employed, Industry Experience and Expertise (multi-select), Fluent Languages, How Did You Hear About CBM, Felony Conviction disclosure, and Terms & Conditions acceptance.

WordPress form posts data to the CRM via the REST API. The CRM automatically creates a Contact record with Contact Type = Mentor, Mentor Status = Submitted, and all submitted field values populated. Terms & Conditions Accepted is set to Yes and Terms & Conditions Acceptance Date/Time is set to the submission timestamp.

System automatically sends a confirmation email to the applicant's personal email address acknowledging receipt of the application and advising that they will be contacted shortly.

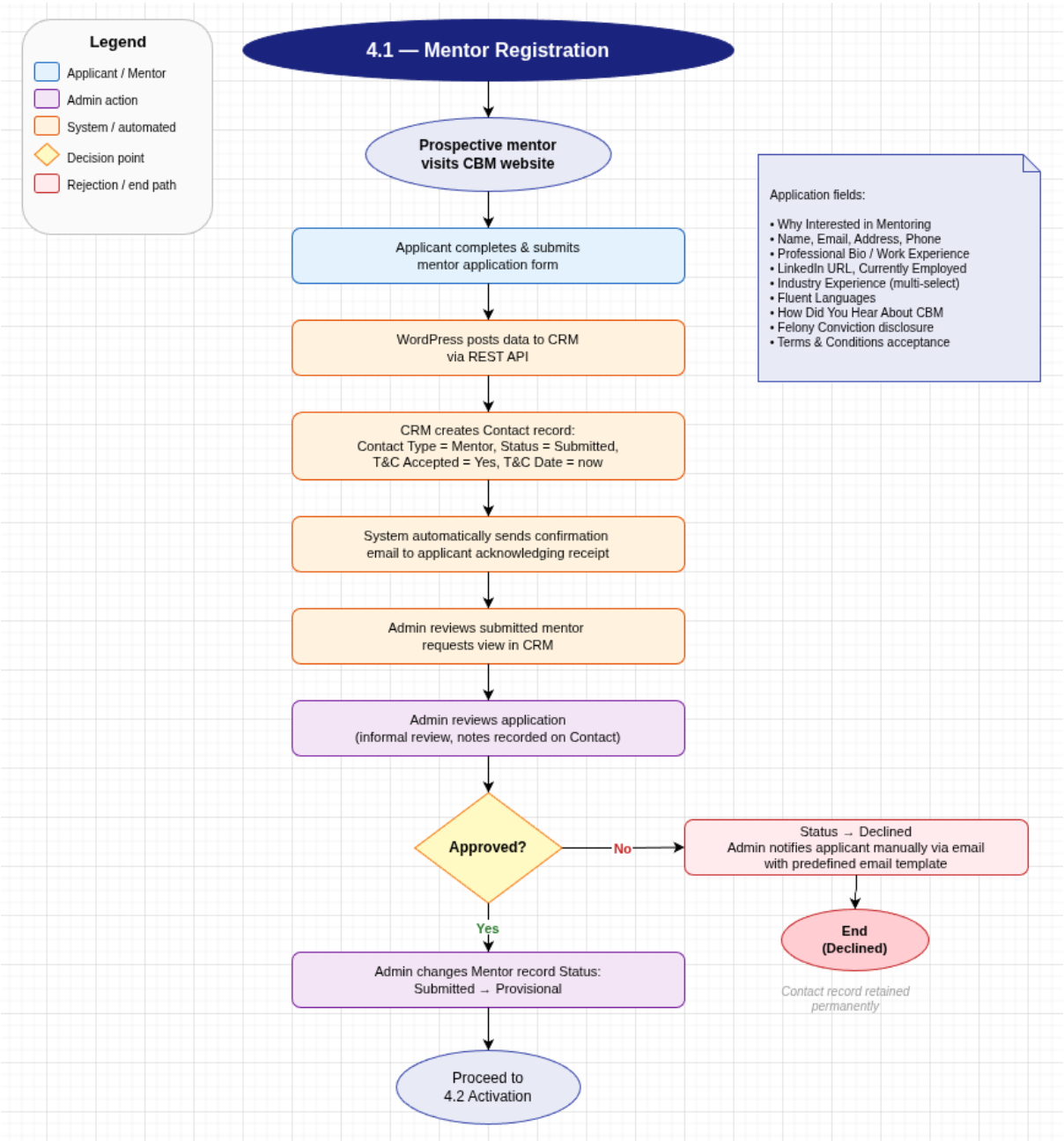
Admin receives an automatic system notification of the new application.

Admin reviews the application. The review process is informal and entirely admin-driven. Notes may be recorded on the Contact record during review. No structured workflow, additional data fields, or automated steps are required for this phase.

If approved: Admin changes Mentor Status from Submitted to Provisional and proceeds to the activation workflow (see Section 4.2).

If declined: Admin changes Mentor Status to Declined and notifies the applicant via email. No automated notification is sent. The Contact record is retained permanently for historical reference.

4.1.1 Mentor Registration Process Diagram



4.2 Provisional → Active Activation

The activation workflow moves a mentor from Provisional to Active status. All steps are manual and admin-driven. Mentor training completion is the only system-triggered step. All seven steps must be completed before Mentor Status is changed to Active.

Admin communicates onboarding requirements to the provisional mentor, including required Mentor training modules and the CBM ethics agreement.

Mentor completes the required Mentor training. Upon completion, the Mentor integration automatically sets Mentor Training Completed = Yes and populates the Mentor Completion Date on the mentor Contact record.

Mentor accepts the CBM ethics agreement. Admin sets Ethics Agreement Accepted = Yes and Ethics Agreement Acceptance Date/Time on the mentor Contact record.

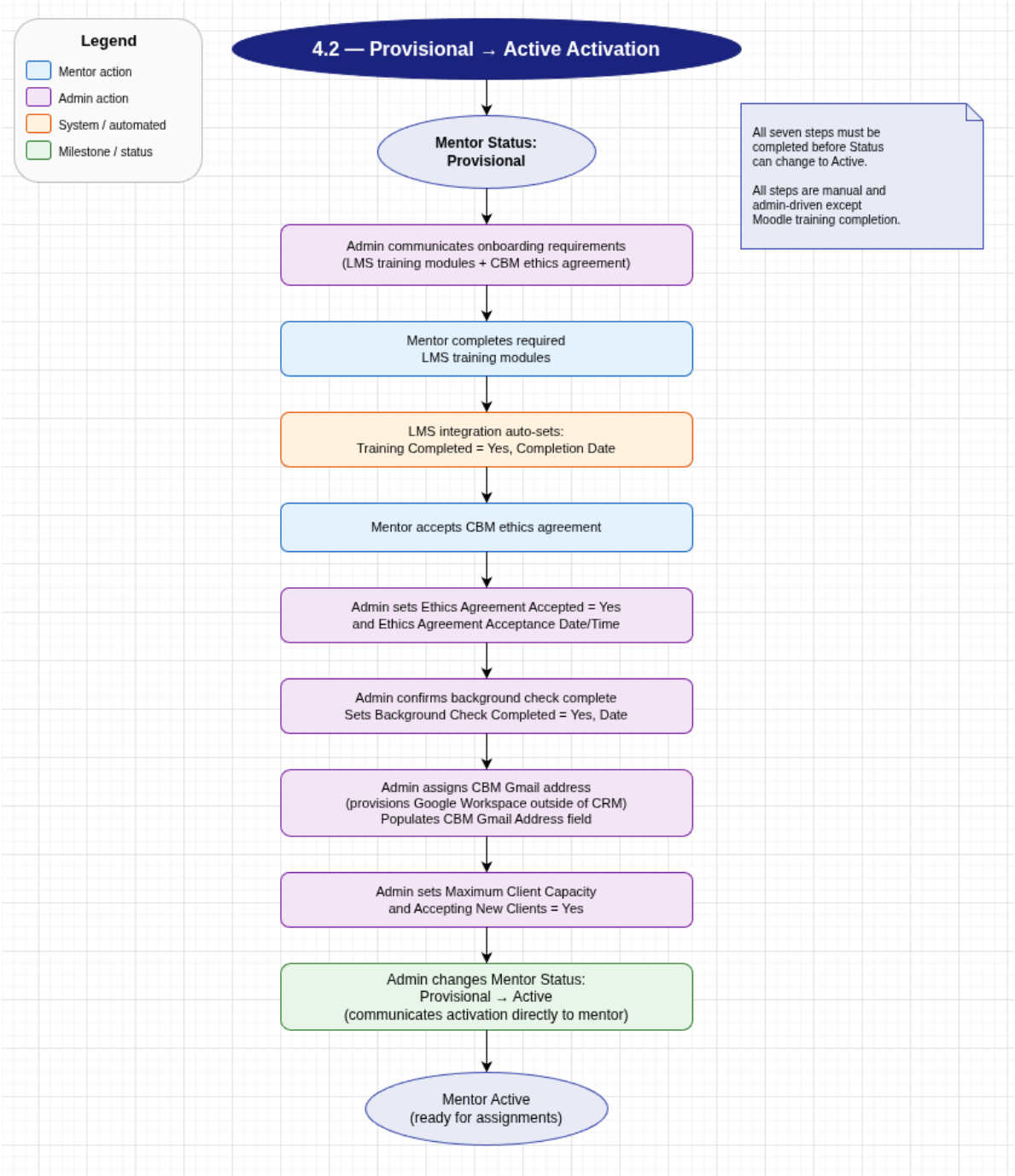
Admin confirms background check is complete (if required) and sets Background Check Completed = Yes and Background Check Date on the mentor Contact record.

Admin assigns the mentor's CBM Gmail address and populates the CBM Gmail Address field on the Contact record. Admin provisions the Google Workspace account separately outside of the CRM.

Admin sets the mentor's Maximum Client Capacity and sets Accepting New Clients = Yes.

Admin changes Mentor Status from Provisional to Active. No automated notification is sent — admin communicates activation to the mentor directly.

4.2.1 Provisional → Active Activation Process Diagram



4.3 Client Assignment

Client assignment is initiated by the admin and is documented in full in CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx (Section 4.2). This section summarizes the mentor-side responsibilities and touchpoints.

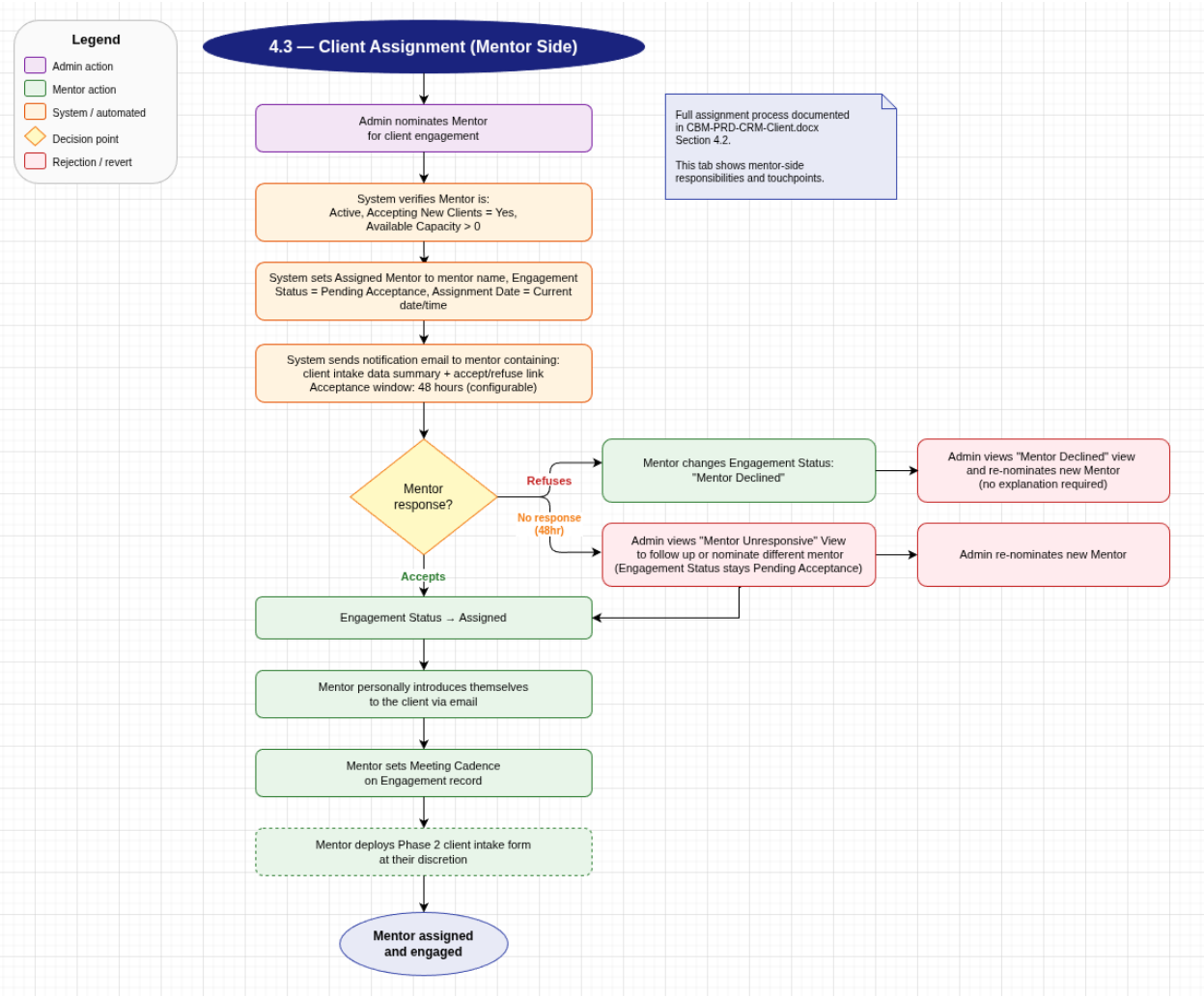
When an admin nominates a mentor for a client engagement, the system verifies that the nominated mentor has a Mentor Status = Active, has Accepting New Clients = Yes, and has Available Capacity greater than zero before allowing the nomination to proceed. The system then sets the Assigned Mentor, and sends the mentor a notification email with a summary of the client's intake data and a link to accept or refuse the assignment. A configurable acceptance window applies (default: 48 hours).

If the mentor accepts: the Engagement status changes to Assigned. The mentor is responsible for personally introducing themselves to the client, setting the Meeting Cadence on the Engagement record, and deploying the Phase 2 client intake form at their discretion.

If the mentor refuses: the Engagement changes Engagement Status to Mentor Declined and the admin will reviews the Mentor Declined View and will proceed to nominate a different mentor. No explanation is required from the refusing mentor.

If there is no response from mentor (Engagement Status = Pending Acceptance and Assignment Date > 48 hours in past) within the acceptance window: the admin will see the Engagement appear in the Mentor Unresponsive view an follow up with mentor or nominate a different mentor. The Engagement Status remains in Pending Acceptance status during this entire process.

4.3.1 Client Assignment Process Diagram

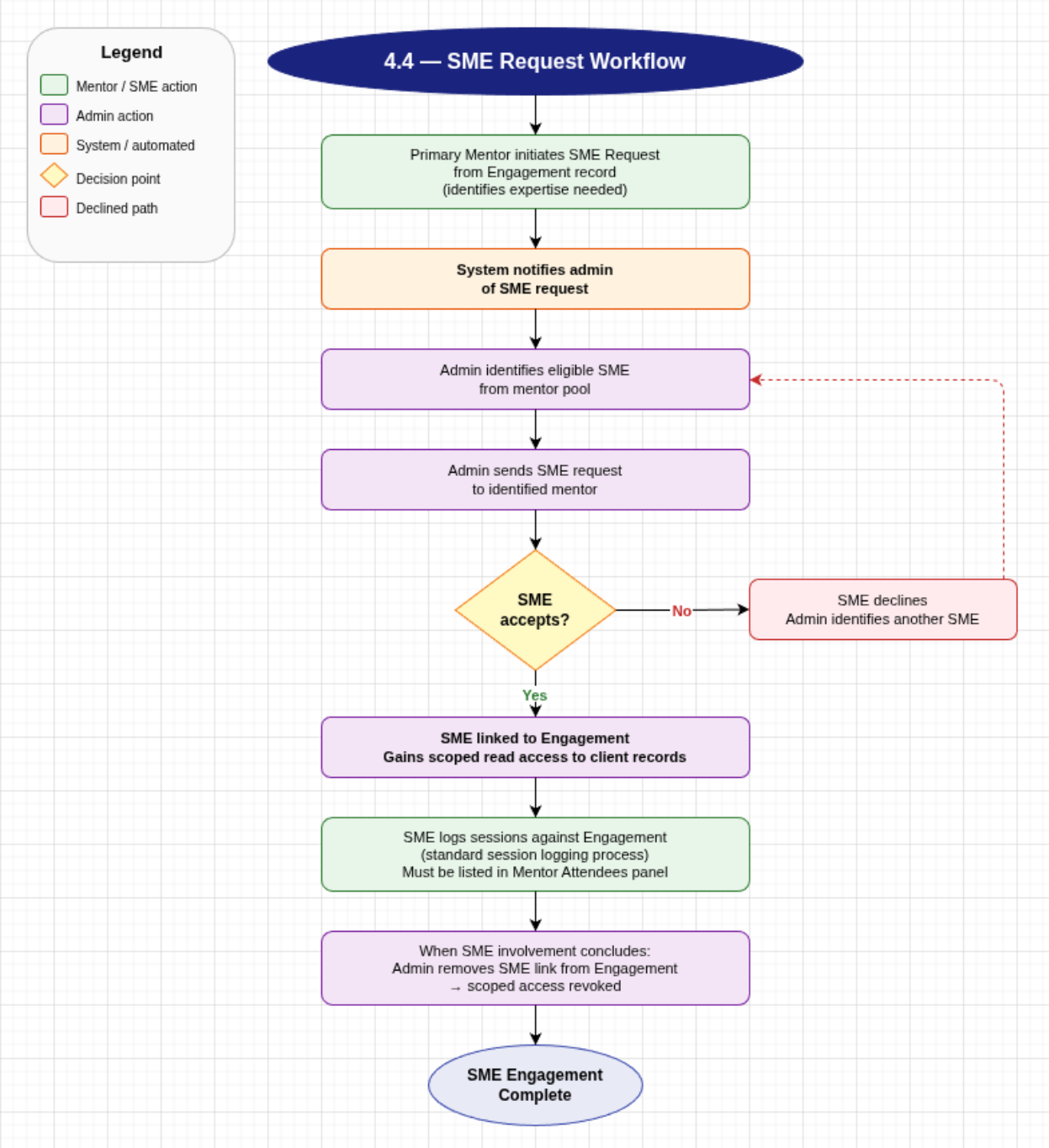


4.4 SME / Co-Mentor Request Workflow

The SME/Co-Mentor Request workflow is initiated by a Primary Mentor who needs specialist expertise for a client engagement. The full workflow is an Engagement-level process and will be documented in CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx. This section defines the mentor-side touchpoints only.

The Primary Mentor initiates an SME/Co-Mentor Request outside of the control of the CRM system via email/call after identifying the expertise needed by searching the CRM Mentor/SME profiles. If SME/Co-Mentor aggrees, the Mentor will add the SME/Co-Mentor to the Engagement record using the SME/Co-Mentor Relationship Panel which will grant the SME/Co-Mentor read/write access to the client records for the duration of their involvement. The SME/Co-Mentor can log Sessions against the Engagement using the standard session logging process and should be listed in the CBM Attendees panel of any session they attend. When the SME's involvement concludes, the admin removes the SME link from the Engagement, revoking their scoped access.

4.4.1 SME / Co-Mentor Request Workflow Process Diagram



4.5 Inactivity Monitoring

Mentor inactivity monitoring tracks whether Active mentors are engaging with clients across all their assigned engagements. It operates at the mentor level, independently of the per-engagement inactivity monitoring defined in CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx (Section 4.5).

A mentor triggers an inactivity alert when all of the following conditions are true for a configurable period (default: 60 days):

No session has been logged on any engagement where the mentor is listed as a Mentor Attendee.

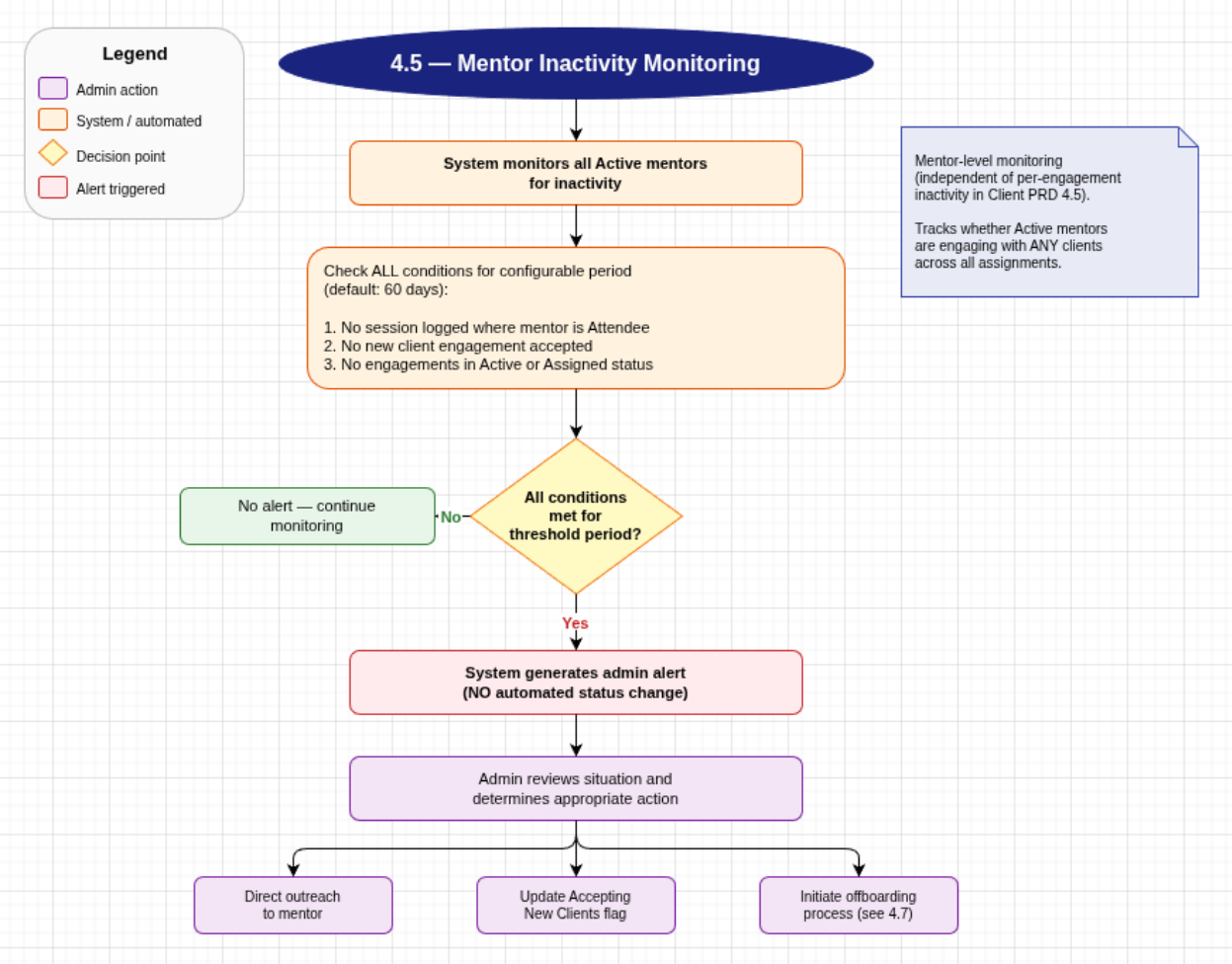
No new client engagement has been accepted by the mentor.

The mentor has no engagements in Active or Assigned status.

When the threshold is exceeded, the system generates an admin alert. No automated status change occurs. The admin reviews the situation and determines the appropriate action, which may include direct outreach to the mentor, updating the Accepting New Clients flag, or initiating the offboarding process.

Note: The inactivity threshold is an admin-configurable system setting. The default of 60 days is a starting point and should be reviewed by CBM leadership before go-live.

4.5.1 Inactivity Monitoring Process Diagram



4.6 Dues Billing & Collection

Annual dues are billed to all Active mentors. The billing process is admin-initiated and tracked via Dues records linked to the mentor Contact record.

Admin creates a Dues record for each Active mentor at the start of the billing cycle and sets Dues Status = Unpaid on the mentor Contact record.

Admin sends a dues invoice to the mentor's CBM Gmail address with a Stripe payment link.

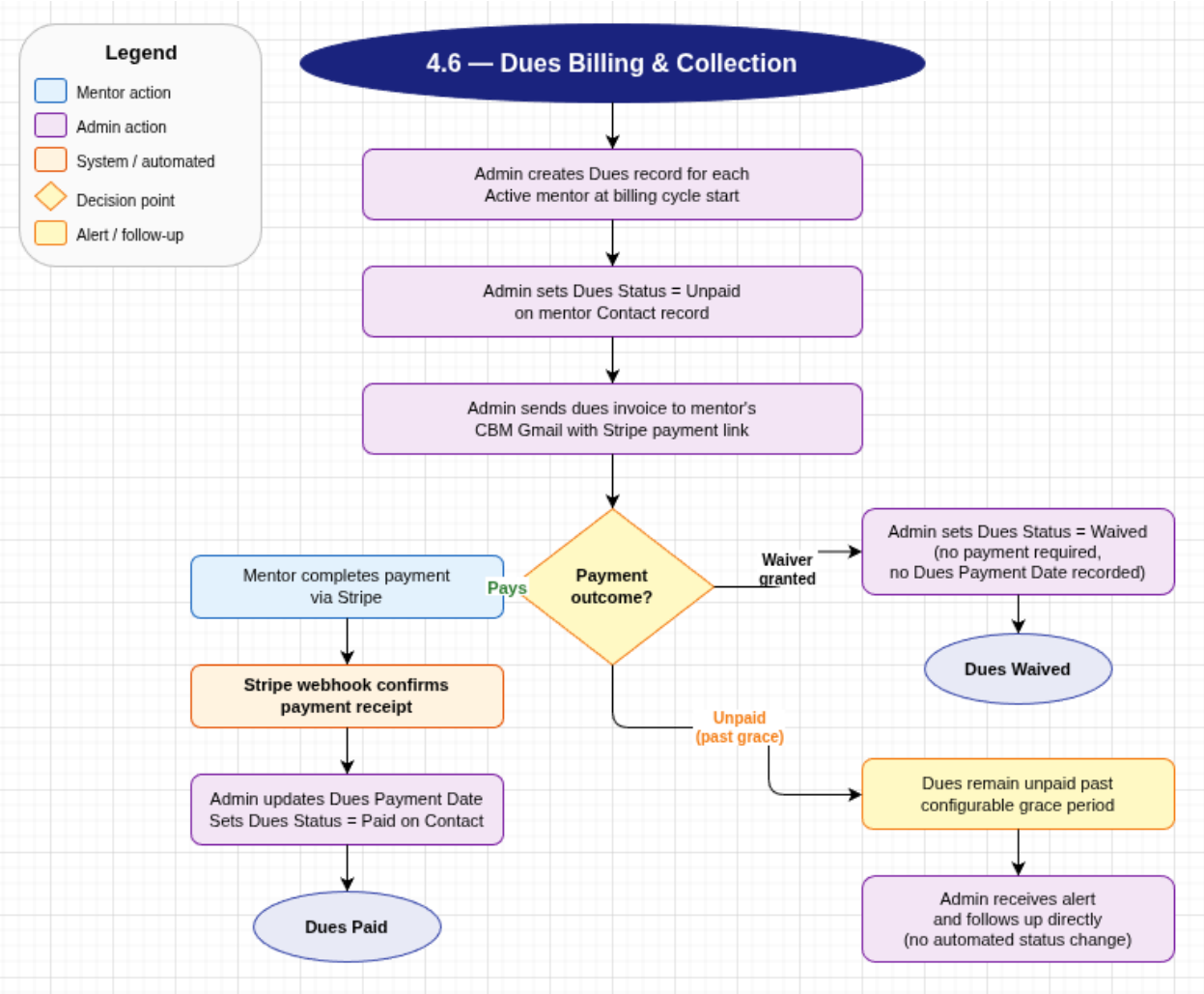
Mentor completes payment via Stripe. Stripe webhook confirms payment receipt.

Admin updates the Dues Payment Date on the Dues record and sets Dues Status = Paid on the mentor Contact record.

If a waiver is granted: Admin sets Dues Status = Waived on the mentor Contact record. No payment is required and no Dues Payment Date is recorded.

If dues remain unpaid after a configurable grace period, the admin receives an alert and follows up with the mentor directly. No automated status change or suspension occurs.

4.6.1 Dues Billing & Collection Process Diagrams



4.7 Mentor Offboarding

Offboarding is initiated by the admin when a mentor departs CBM. All steps are manual and admin-driven.

Admin changes Mentor Status to Departed on the mentor Contact record, sets Departure Date, and selects Departure Reason.

Admin sets Accepting New Clients = No.

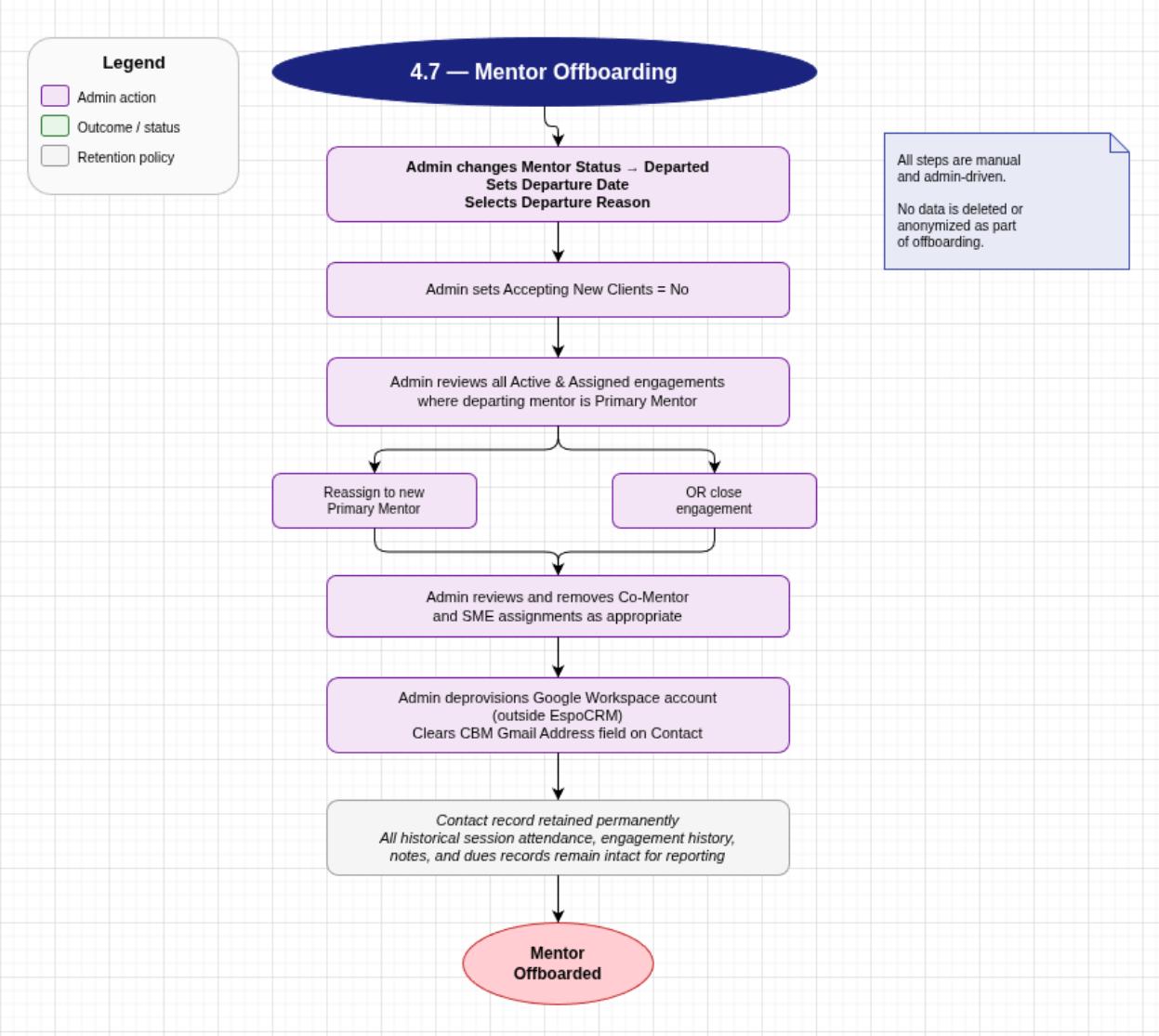
Admin reviews all Active and Assigned engagements where the departing mentor is the Primary Mentor. Each must be reassigned to a new Primary Mentor or closed before offboarding is complete. Co-Mentor and SME assignments are reviewed and removed as appropriate.

Admin deprovisions the mentor's CBM Google Workspace account outside of the CRM and clears the CBM Gmail Address field on the Contact record.

The mentor Contact record is retained permanently. All historical session attendance, engagement history, notes, and dues records remain intact for reporting purposes.

No data is deleted or anonymized as part of offboarding.

4.7.1 Mentor Offboarding Process Diagram



5. Security

5.1 Role-Based Access Control

The following tables define Create, Read, Update, and Delete permissions for each role across mentor domain entities. “Own” means the role can perform the action only on records they are directly assigned to or own. “All” means the role can perform the action across all records of that type.

Mentor Contact

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access including all administrative and restricted fields.
Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Can read and update their own Contact record. Administrative fields are read-only or hidden per Section 5.2.
Board Member	No	List only	No	No	List view access only. Cannot open individual mentor Contact records.

Engagement

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access.
Primary Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Can read and update Engagements where assigned as Primary Mentor. Cannot change status to Completed or Abandoned — admin only.
Co-Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Scoped to Engagements where assigned as Co-Mentor. Same update rights as Primary Mentor.
SME	No	Own	No	No	Read only. Scoped to Engagements where assigned as SME.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access to individual Engagement records.

Session

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access.
Primary Mentor	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create and edit sessions on own Engagements. Must be listed in Mentor Attendees panel on sessions they attend.
Co-Mentor	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create and edit sessions on assigned Engagements.
SME	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create and edit sessions on

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
					assigned Engagements.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access.

Dues

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access.
Mentor	No	Own	No	No	Read only on own Dues records.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access to individual Dues records.

5.2 Field-Level Security

The following fields on the mentor Contact record have access restrictions more granular than the role-level permissions defined in Section 5.1. These restrictions are implemented through the CRM's field-level access control configuration. All other fields in Groups 1 through 4 are fully editable by the mentor on their own Contact record.

Field	Mentor Access	Rationale
Ethics Agreement Accepted	Read only	Mentor can see their acceptance status but cannot modify it — admin-controlled.
Ethics Agreement Acceptance Date/Time	Read only	Same as above.
Terms & Conditions Accepted	Read only	System-populated on form submission. Mentor can see but not modify.
Terms & Conditions Acceptance Date/Time	Read only	Same as above.
Mentor Training Completed	Read only	System-populated via LMS integration. Mentor can see their training status.
Mentor Training Completion Date	Read only	Same as above.
Dues Status	Read only	Mentor can see their dues standing but cannot modify it — admin-controlled.
Dues Payment Date	Read only	Same as above.
CBM Gmail Address	Read only	Admin-populated. Mentor can see their assigned address but cannot modify it.
Background Check Completed	Hidden	Admin-only. Not visible to mentor.
Background Check Date	Hidden	Admin-only. Not visible to mentor.
Felony Conviction	Hidden	Admin-only. Restricted field. Not visible to mentor after form submission.
Departure Reason	Hidden	Admin-only. Not applicable while mentor is active.

Field	Mentor Access	Rationale
Departure Date	Hidden	Admin-only. Not applicable while mentor is active.

5.3 Data Visibility Rules

Data visibility rules govern which records each role can see within the CRM, independent of field-level permissions. These rules are implemented through the CRM's Teams and Owner-based access model.

- Admin — Full visibility across all mentor Contact records, Engagement records, Session records, and Dues records. No restrictions.
- Mentor — Sees only their own Contact record. Sees only Engagements where they are assigned as Primary Mentor, Co-Mentor, or SME. Sees only Sessions linked to their assigned Engagements. Sees only their own Dues records.
- Board Member — List view access only on mentor Contact records. Cannot open individual Contact records. No access to Engagement, Session, or Dues records of any kind.
- Clients — No CRM access of any kind. All client-facing communication is conducted via email.

Mentors serving in multiple roles across different Engagements (for example, Primary Mentor on one Engagement and Co-Mentor on another) see all records where they are assigned in any capacity. The CRM's role-based filtering handles this naturally without custom configuration.

6. Implementation

Implementation steps for the mentor domain are documented in CBM-PRD-CRM-Implementation.docx. That document provides the complete sequenced configuration guide covering all entities, fields, relationships, roles, workflows, integrations, and testing procedures across both the client and mentor domains.

7. Document Control

Field	Value
Version	0.2
Status	In Progress — Pending Detail Definition
Last Updated	March 18, 2026
Next Review	After initial CRM mentor entity configuration
Related Documents	CBM-PRD-CRM.docx, CBM-PRD-CRM-Client.docx